

LEDGER

Personal Budget & Finance Tracker

User Guide & Tester Checklist

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What is Ledger?

Ledger is a personal budget app that helps you track income, expenses, and recurring bills all in one place. You import your bank statements, review the transactions, and the app organizes everything by month. Over time it builds a complete financial history you can search, filter, and analyze.

How to Open the App

Open the app link in any web browser on your phone or computer. You do not need to download anything from an app store.

Signing In

1. On the sign-in screen, click Sign in with Google.
2. Choose any Google account. Your data is private — other users cannot see it.
3. You will land on the Dashboard after signing in.

TIP: Every change in the app saves automatically to the cloud. There is no Save button — just make your change and it is done.

Getting Around

Use the navigation bar at the bottom of the screen (mobile) or the left sidebar (desktop) to move between sections:

Dashboard — Your monthly summary — income, spending, bills at a glance

Import — Upload bank statements to bring in new transactions

Ledger — Browse and edit all your saved transactions

Bills — Manage recurring bills and split them by paycheck

Analytics — Charts and spending breakdowns over time

Rules — Set up automatic category rules for future

TIP: The month selector at the top of every page controls which month you are viewing. Always check you are on the right month before reviewing your data.

What You See Here

The Dashboard is your starting point each time you open the app. It gives you a quick snapshot of the selected month: how much money came in, how much went out, your balance, and the status of your bills.

THE SUMMARY CARDS

Five cards appear at the top of the dashboard:

Total Income: All money coming in this month — paychecks, deposits, etc.

Total Spending: All money going out this month — every expense you imported

Balance: Income minus spending — your net result for the month

Bills Due: How many recurring bills have not been marked paid yet

Bills Paid: The total dollar amount of bills you have already checked

SPENDING BY CATEGORY

Below the cards is a breakdown of your spending split on. This updates instantly when you import or edit transactions.

RECENT TRANSACTIONS

The bottom of the dashboard shows your most recent transactions for reference only — to edit them go to the Ledger section.

TIP: Switch months using the selector at the top to review any past month. All cards and charts recalculate automatically.

What Import Does

Import is how you bring your bank transactions into the app. You upload a file from your bank, the app reads it, and shows you a preview. You review each transaction, fix any categories that need adjusting, then confirm. Nothing is saved until you hit Confirm Import.

METHOD 1 — CSV FILE

1. Go to Import. Make sure CSV is selected at the top.
2. Click Select CSV File and choose the file you downloaded from your bank website.
3. A table appears listing every transaction found in the file.
4. Review each row. The app will have already guessed the category for most of them.
5. Each row has an Action dropdown with three choices: Save (keep it), Skip (ignore it), or Review (flag it to come back to).
6. When the list looks right, click Confirm Import. The saved transactions appear in your Ledger.

TIP: To download a CSV from your bank, log into your bank's website, go to your transaction history, and look for an Export or Download option. Choose CSV format.

METHOD 2 — AI VISION (PDF OR SCREENSHOT)

1. Go to Import and select AI Vision at the top.
2. Click Upload Statement and choose a PDF or image of your bank statement.
3. The AI reads the document and pulls out all income and expense transactions. This takes about 10 to 20 seconds.
4. You see the same preview table — review, adjust categories, then Confirm Import.

TIP: AI Vision works with PDF files, JPG photos, PNG screenshots, and HEIC images. If your bank does not offer CSV download, take a screenshot of your statement and use this method.

MARKING A TRANSACTION AS A RECURRING BILL DURING IMPORT

This is a shortcut that saves time. While reviewing your import list, every expense row shows a small Add Recurring button below its category dropdown.

1. Find a transaction that is a bill you pay every month (like a car note or subscription).
2. Click the Add Recurring button on that row. It lights up green.
3. When you click Confirm Import, those transactions automatically create entries in your Bills list with the correct name, amount, and due day.

A counter appears in the summary bar showing how many you have marked. The success message after import tells you exactly how many recurring bills were added.

DUPLICATE DETECTION

If a transaction was already imported before, the app flags it in yellow as a Potential Duplicate. You can still save it if you want, but the warning helps you avoid counting the same charge twice.

What the Ledger Is

The Ledger is your full transaction history — every income and expense entry ever imported or added manually, organized by month. It works like a digital checkbook. You can search, filter, edit, and delete anything from here.

READING THE LIST

Each row shows the date, transaction name, a category badge, the amount, and a status indicator. Income entries show a green plus sign. Transactions flagged for review show in orange.

SEARCHING AND FILTERING

1. Use the search bar at the top to find any transaction by name as you type.
2. Use the category filter to show only one category at a time — Bills, Fuel, Shopping, etc.
3. Switch months with the month selector to view any past month.

EDITING A TRANSACTION

1. Click the pencil icon on the row you want to edit.
2. A form appears where you can change the name, amount, date, category, or status.
3. Click Save. The change shows everywhere immediately — Dashboard totals and Analytics charts update right away.

DELETING A TRANSACTION

1. Click the trash icon on the row.
2. Confirm the deletion. The transaction is permanently removed.

TIP: Deleting a transaction from the Ledger does NOT affect your Bills list. Bills and transactions are separate things — bills are a template of recurring charges, transactions are your actual imported history.

ADDING A TRANSACTION MANUALLY

If a charge did not show up in your import, you can add it by hand. Click the plus button at the top of the Ledger. Fill in the date, name, amount, and category, then save.

INCOME TRANSACTIONS

Paychecks and deposits get their own income category — Paycheck, Freelance, Transfer, or Other Income. These feed the Total Income card on the Dashboard separately from your expenses.

What Bill Manager Is

Bill Manager holds your list of recurring charges — rent, car notes, subscriptions, utilities, medical payments, anything that repeats. You set them up once and they appear every month automatically without re-entering them.

Bill Manager is your bill template, not your transaction history. Think of it as a list pinned to your refrigerator that you check off as you pay each bill every month.

THREE WAYS TO ADD BILLS

Option A — Paste List (Fastest)

If you have a list of all your bills, you can import them all at once.

Vehicle:

1. Click the Paste List button in the header.

03/23 — Oklahoma Motor Credit: \$290.00

2. A text box appears. Paste your bills using this format — a section header ending with a colon, then one bill per line with the date and dollar amount:

Subscriptions:

Monthly — Netflix: \$7.00

Monthly — ChatGPT: \$21.19

3. Click Parse Bills. The app reads your list and shows a preview table.

4. In the preview, every row is editable. Click into any name, amount, or day number to correct it. Click the X on a row to remove a bill you do not want.

5. Click Import All Bills to save everything remaining in the table.

Option B — Mark During Import

While reviewing a bank statement import, click Add Recurring on any expense row. On confirm, that transaction automatically becomes a bill entry. See the Import section for full details.

Option C — Add Manually

Click the plus button at the top of Bill Manager. Fill in the name, amount, due day (a number from 1 to 31), category, and whether it repeats every month. Save it.

EDITING OR DELETING A BILL

1. Pencil icon — opens an edit form on that bill. Change the name, amount, due day, or category and save.

The update applies to every future month immediately.

2. Trash icon — permanently removes the bill from your list. It disappears from all future months.

TIP: If a bill amount changes, like your phone plan increases, edit that bill once in Bill Manager and the new amount shows up for the current month and all future months.

MARKING BILLS AS PAID

Each bill row has a circle button on the right side. Tap it when you pay the bill. A green checkmark appears and the row dims. Tap it again to un-mark it.

Paid status is tracked separately per month. Marking February's rent paid does not change March's status.

PAYCHECK PLANNER

The Paycheck Planner splits your bills into two groups based on which paycheck window covers them. This is useful if you get paid twice a month.

1. Click the Paycheck button and enter your two pay days, for example day 6 and day 20.
2. Two panels appear side by side: Paycheck 1 and Paycheck 2.
3. Each panel shows the bills that fall in that window, the total amount, and how much is already paid.
Bills sort automatically into the correct window based on their due day. Each bill shows its day number and name clearly.

DETECT — AUTO-FIND RECURRING BILLS

The Detect button scans your imported transaction history and looks for charges that appeared in multiple months around the same date with similar amounts. It flags these as likely recurring bills.

1. Click Detect (the scan icon in the header).
2. A list of suggested recurring bills appears. Bills already in your list are marked with a blue Already Tracked badge.
3. Check the ones you want to add and uncheck any you do not want.
4. Click Add Selected to save them.

TIP: Detect works best after you have imported at least two months of bank statements. The more history it has, the more accurately it finds patterns.

What Analytics Shows

Analytics gives you charts and breakdowns of your spending. It is view-only — nothing here can be edited — but it helps you spot patterns and understand where your money is going.

SPENDING BY CATEGORY

A chart shows the percentage and dollar amount that went to each category this month. You can see at a glance whether Bills, Fuel, or Shopping is your biggest expense area.

MONTH-OVER-MONTH COMPARISON

A bar chart compares your total income and spending across the past several months so you can see whether your spending is trending up or down.

TIP: If a chart looks empty, it means no transactions have been imported for that month yet. Import a statement and the charts fill in automatically.

What the Rules Engine Is

The Rules Engine lets you create automatic category assignments so that future imports require less manual review. For example: any transaction with Planet Fitness in the name should always be categorized as Bills. Once the rule is active, every future import applies it for you.

CREATING A RULE

1. Go to Rules and click Add Rule.
2. Set the condition — pick a field like Name, set an operator like contains, and type the value to match.
3. Set the action — usually Set Category, then choose which category.
4. Set a priority number. Lower numbers run first if multiple rules could match the same transaction.
5. Click Save Rule.

TESTING A RULE WITH THE SANDBOX

Before saving a rule you can test it against your existing transaction history to make sure it works correctly.

1. Build your rule condition and action.
2. Click Run Test without saving yet.
3. The app shows every past transaction that this rule would have matched and what category it would set.
4. If the results look right, click Save. If not, adjust the condition and test again.

TIP: Rules only apply to new imports going forward. They do not retroactively change transactions you have already saved. To fix past transactions, edit them individually in the Ledger.

MANAGING RULES

From the rules list you can toggle any rule on or off without deleting it, edit the condition or action, change the priority order, or delete a rule entirely.

How to Use This Checklist

Work through each item in order. Check the box when the feature works as described. If something does not work, write a note about what you expected vs. what actually happened and send it back to the developer. You do not have to finish everything in one session.

ACCOUNT & SIGN IN

- ☐ App opens at the URL without any error message
 - ☐ Sign in with Google button works and you reach the Dashboard
 - ☐ Signing out and signing back in restores your data
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DASHBOARD

- ☐ All five summary cards are visible: Income, Spending, Balance, Bills Due, Bills Paid
 - ☐ Switching months with the month selector updates the card values
 - ☐ Spending by category section appears below the cards
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IMPORT — CSV

- ☐ Selecting CSV mode and clicking Select CSV File opens a file picker
 - ☐ Uploading a bank CSV shows a preview table of transactions
 - ☐ Category dropdowns on each row let you change the category
 - ☐ Action dropdowns let you set Save, Skip, or Review on each row
 - ☐ Re-importing the same file highlights duplicates in yellow
 - ☐ Confirm Import saves the transactions and you are taken to the Ledger
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IMPORT — AI VISION

- ☐ Selecting AI Vision and clicking Upload Statement opens a file picker
 - ☐ Uploading a PDF or image shows a loading spinner while AI reads it
 - ☐ After analysis, a preview table of extracted transactions appears
 - ☐ Both income and expense transactions appear in the table
 - ☐ Add Recurring button appears below the category dropdown on expense rows
 - ☐ Clicking Add Recurring highlights it in green
 - ☐ Confirming import shows a success message that includes how many recurring bills were added
 - ☐ The newly marked bills appear in Bill Manager after import
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LEDGER

- ☐ Imported transactions show in the Ledger under the correct month
- ☐

Search bar filters the list by name as you type

- ☐ Category filter dropdown narrows the list correctly
 - ☐ Pencil icon opens an edit form for a transaction
 - ☐ Editing a transaction and saving updates it immediately everywhere
 - ☐ Trash icon deletes a transaction after you confirm
 - ☐ Adding a transaction manually with the plus button works
 - ☐ Income transactions show with a green label
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BILL MANAGER

- ☐ Paste List button opens a text box dialog
 - ☐ Pasting a bill list and clicking Parse Bills shows a preview table
 - ☐ Name, amount, and day fields in the preview table are editable
 - ☐ X button removes a row from the preview before importing
 - ☐ Import All Bills saves the remaining rows and they appear in the bill list
 - ☐ Each bill row shows a day number with the word day labeled beneath it
 - ☐ Pencil icon opens an edit form and saves changes correctly
 - ☐ Trash icon removes a bill from the list permanently
 - ☐ Circle button marks a bill as paid with a green checkmark
 - ☐ Marking paid in one month does not change other months
 - ☐ Paycheck button opens a form to enter two pay days
 - ☐ After setting pay days, two side-by-side paycheck panels appear
 - ☐ Bills in the paycheck panels show the correct day number, name, and amount
 - ☐ Detect button scans history and suggests recurring bills
 - ☐ Bills already in your list show a blue Already Tracked badge in Detect results
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ANALYTICS

- ☐ Analytics page loads without errors
 - ☐ Spending chart shows category breakdown for months that have imported data
 - ☐ Month-over-month chart appears when multiple months have data
 - ☐ Switching months updates the charts
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RULES ENGINE

- ☐ Rules page loads and shows existing rules or an empty state message
- ☐ Add Rule form accepts condition and action input
- ☐ Run Test in the sandbox shows matching transactions from your history
- ☐

Saving a rule adds it to the list

- ☐ Toggling a rule off disables it without deleting it
 - ☐ Deleting a rule removes it from the list
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GENERAL

- ☐ App works on a mobile phone browser
- ☐ No unexpected error messages appear during normal use
- ☐ Navigation between all six sections works without errors
- ☐ Thank you for testing! Please report any issues with the feature name, what you expected, and what actually happened.

